

**UNITED STATES OF AMERICA
BEFORE THE
FEDERAL ENERGY REGULATORY COMMISSION**

Interconnection of Large Loads to the Interstate Transmission System	Docket No. RM26-4-000
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INITIAL COMMENTS OF FERVO ENERGY COMPANY

In accordance with the October 27, 2025 and November 7, 2025 notices of the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission (the “Commission” or “FERC”), Fervo Energy Company (“Fervo”) submits initial comments on the advance notice of proposed rulemaking (“ANOPR”) on large load interconnection released by the Secretary of Energy.¹ Fervo generally supports the effort to address interconnection of large loads reflected in the ANOPR and provides comments responsive to the ANOPR.

Executive Summary

Fervo supports the Commission’s efforts to provide greater clarity, standardization, and efficiency in the interconnection process for large loads and hybrid facilities. In particular, the proposed enhancements to readiness requirements and the coordinated study of load and generation address challenges that Fervo has encountered firsthand. These reforms have the potential to enable Fervo’s emerging hybrid geothermal projects to reliably and cost-effectively serve large industrial loads. With well-designed improvements to the interconnection framework, the Commission can help unlock the development of reliable, baseload geothermal resources and large-load facilities alike, thereby strengthening U.S. energy security, supporting

¹ *Interconnection of Large Loads to the Interstate Transmission System*, Advanced Notice of Proposed Rulemaking, Docket No. RM26-4-000 (Oct. 27, 2025) (ANOPR).

economic growth, and ensuring robust power availability for rapidly expanding sectors such as advanced computing and artificial intelligence.

I. About Fervo.

Fervo Energy (“Fervo”) is a next-generation geothermal developer deploying Enhanced Geothermal Systems (“EGS”) to provide 24/7, dispatchable, carbon-free power by applying proven technologies from the oil and gas sector. Next-generation geothermal resources have the potential to supply tens of gigawatts of reliable, baseload capacity to the U.S. electric grid over the next decade. However, growing interconnection congestion has constrained the pace at which these resources can be developed and deployed. Timely, efficient interconnection access for geothermal projects is essential to ensuring that geothermal energy can play a central role in advancing the nation’s energy-dominance and reliability objectives.

II. Comments.

Fervo’s comments are organized around the set of principles, First through Fourteenth, identified in the ANOPR (paragraphs 18-31), and more specifically the specific requests for comments raised in the ANOPR with respect to those various principles. Fervo does not provide comment in response to every principle, and it reserves the right to provide further comments in possible reply comments.

A. Second Principle: We seek comment on alternative thresholds, including whether such a threshold is necessary at all.

Fervo Comments: Fervo agrees that a 20 MW threshold is reasonable, appropriately tailored to the types of high-impact projects this rulemaking is intended to address, and fully

consistent with the structure of the existing pro forma LGIP and LGIA. The LGIP framework is the Commission's established mechanism for studying and processing generation interconnection requests that can materially affect transmission system reliability. Aligning the applicability threshold for large-load and hybrid interconnections with this framework can ensure procedural consistency, reduce administrative complexity for transmission providers, and create a predictable pathway for customers whose system impacts are similar to those of large generators.

B. Fourth Principle: We seek comment on the extent to which the existing study deposits, readiness requirements, and withdrawal penalties can be adopted. We also seek comment on whether additional commitments or financial penalties would be appropriate.

Fervo Comments: Fervo supports the Commission's focus on ensuring that large-load and hybrid interconnection customers demonstrate commercial readiness before entering and advancing through the interconnection queue. Fervo encourages the Commission to prioritize readiness criteria that mirror the maturity expectations already applied to large generator interconnection customers, including demonstrated site control or contracting milestones. Applying a readiness framework to load and hybrid customers can help transmission providers distinguish commercially viable projects, improve queue efficiency, and reduce speculative requests without imposing unnecessary financial barriers.

C. Sixth Principle: We seek comment on whether other operational limitations should be considered. We also seek comment on the minimum technical requirements for such system protection facilities, whether a hybrid interconnection customer should be subject to penalties for unauthorized injections or withdrawals, how any such penalties should be designed, and how such penalties should be allocated to other transmission customers.

Fervo Comments: Fervo agrees that appropriate system-protection requirements may be necessary for hybrid facilities but emphasizes that such requirements should be proportionate to the actual operational characteristics and risks of the resource. Geothermal has stable and predictable operating profiles and does not exhibit fast-changing injection or withdrawal patterns that drive many protection concerns for other technologies. As a result, protection systems for these hybrids can be tailored rather than broadly prescriptive, ensuring reliability without imposing unnecessary or overly burdensome technical mandates. Fervo also encourages the Commission to ensure that any enforcement mechanisms or operational limits for unauthorized injections or withdrawals reflect the physical realities of hybrid geothermal operations and do not inadvertently constrain resources that already pose minimal system-protection risk.

D. Seventh Principle: We seek comment on whether this should be accomplished through a serial interconnection study process or by some other means. We also seek comment on appropriate deadlines for such an expedited study process, including whether such studies can be completed in 60 days.

Fervo Comments: Fervo supports the Commission's proposal to expedite interconnection studies for large loads and hybrid facilities that agree to be curtailable or dispatchable, as these operational flexibilities materially reduce system impacts and allow transmission providers to study such projects with greater confidence. Geothermal-based hybrid projects are particularly well suited for this approach because they can provide highly predictable, operator-controlled responses that improve system reliability during peak or contingency events. An expedited study process that recognizes the reliability value of curtailable or dispatchable hybrids would help accelerate deployment of clean firm resources while allowing transmission providers to prioritize projects that offer the greatest operational benefit. Fervo encourages the Commission to ensure

that the expedited pathway is structured to account for the unique controllability characteristics of hybrid geothermal facilities and supports clear timelines that maintain study discipline without compromising reliability.

E. Eighth Principle: We seek comment on whether such costs should be offset through a crediting mechanism and, if so, over how many years.

Fervo Comments: Fervo supports clear cost-allocation rules but emphasizes that any cost-allocation framework must recognize when a project's design meaningfully reduces its system impact. Hybrid geothermal facilities that "bring their own power" can substantially decrease the need for upstream transmission reinforcements by co-locating firm, dispatchable generation with load, often avoiding or minimizing upgrades that a stand-alone load would otherwise require. Fervo therefore encourages the Commission to ensure that cost responsibility is applied in a way that reflects actual system benefits and not over-assign costs to hybrids that reduce net flows or improve local reliability. Where appropriate, crediting mechanisms should remain available to acknowledge these benefits and maintain fair treatment across different project types.

F. Thirteenth Principle: We seek comment on appropriate transition plans, including the treatment of large load interconnections that are already being studied for interconnection.

Fervo Comments: Fervo supports the Commission's effort to establish a clear and orderly transition plan and encourages the Commission to design that transition to recognize the system benefits of projects that co-locate large loads with clean generation. Fervo therefore recommends that generation projects already in the generation interconnection queue, or in late-stage development, be permitted to elect into the new coordinated hybrid study framework where

doing so would better reflect these reduced system impacts. Allowing transmission providers to apply the new modeling assumptions, hybrid treatment rules, and coordinated study processes to existing queue positions, without forcing restudy or loss of queue priority, would ensure that early geothermal hybrid projects can access the benefits of reforms intended for exactly this type of configuration.

III. Conclusion.

Fervo appreciates the opportunity to provide its comments in response to the ANOPR and looks forward to further participation on these important topics through the course of the anticipated notice of proposed rulemaking.

Respectfully submitted,

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On behalf of Fervo Energy Company

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